



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital Identity and CRVS: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-28

Edition of 2026-08-28 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
ADLI cohort on the AfCFTA Digital Identity Annex	Did not exist	Six countries across three trade corridors working on compliance with the annex, on a test-and-learn basis; no assessment or mutual-recognition decision held	ADVANCED
Adults holding official identification in Sub-Saharan Africa	None published on this basis	81% of adults, 82% of men against 79% of women, a 3.56-point gender gap (2025)	BASELINE NOT HELD
APAI-CRVS (Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics)	BASELINE NOT HELD	The 2017-2026 decade is closing and a 2027-2036 phase is opening; the African eCRVS Shared Asset (ACSA) is named as the shared continental standard intended to cut fragmented digital procurement across country systems, and Equatorial Guinea's Justice Ministry timed a free registration campaign for children aged 0-5 (10-14 August 2026) to the decade's close. No AU statement of the new phase's content, financing or targets is held	Baseline not held
Continental ID and data-protection law analyser	Baseline not held	An open-source tool launched by a university research network comparing identity and data-protection laws across more than 50 African countries, built as a retrieval-augmented chatbot and stated as intended to help states harmonise their frameworks; no usage figure, governance arrangement or maintenance commitment is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Smart Africa digital identity blueprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	The alliance secretariat's first-edition blueprint for mutually recognised digital identity across member states, setting out the trust alliance, levels of assurance and the case for interoperable identity, drawn up after a member-state workshop	Baseline not held

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
SADC cross-border digital-ID and eKYC framework	A South Africa-Lesotho verification pilot, no regional framework	Federated framework announced for all 16 member states; no build, budget or launch date on record in the year since	ADVANCED

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
AES biometric passport	Launched in January 2025, with no state-by-state issuance on record	Issuing in all three states, with Mali's supplied by China's Emptech in place of France's Idemia	ADVANCED
CIB-AES (AES biometric identity card)	Did not exist	Issuing in Burkina Faso since December 2025 and in Niger since March 2026, with mass enrolment under way and cross-border enrolment tested in Mali	ADVANCED
ENBIC (ECOWAS National Biometric Identity Card)	Operationalised by six member states, with no rollout held in the largest	Rolled out by Nigeria in November 2025 and deployed in the field in Guinea-Bissau under a cross-border traders' project	ADVANCED
UEMOA customer identification and verification instruction (003-03-2025)	Did not exist in this form	In force since March 2025: how financial institutions must identify customers, verify identity and know their clientele across the monetary union	ADVANCED
WURI (West Africa Unique Identification for Regional Integration and Inclusion)	Phase 2 running to a closing date of 30 July 2026, with no interoperability strategy validated	A cross-border interoperability and mutual-recognition strategy validated and a 2026 work plan adopted; the phase's stated closing date has passed with no completion, extension or successor record held	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-28
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.